Safe Water for Rural Schools

Programme report for the year 2025 · Prepared by the Programme Office, March 2026

1. Executive Summary

In 2025 the initiative completed 42 new boreholes and rehabilitated 14 older wells across thirteen districts, bringing safe drinking water to an estimated 32,700 people. Construction costs per borehole fell by 12 percent compared with the previous year, mainly because drilling teams were shared between neighbouring districts. School attendance in the twelve pilot villages rose during the dry season, when children previously spent their mornings fetching water.

> Key figure: 94 percent of the water points built since 2021 were functional at the December inspection.

2. Programme Activities

2.1 Borehole construction

Drilling started in January and paused for eleven weeks during the rainy season. Each site was surveyed by a hydrogeologist before any equipment was moved. Two sites were abandoned after test drilling found only saline water, and the budget for them was transferred to well rehabilitation.

2.2 Water committees

Every new water point is handed over to a committee elected by the village. Committees collect a small monthly fee that pays for spare parts and for the caretaker's time. The figures below summarise the state of the committees at the end of the year.

- Committees trained in 2025: 42
- Committees with at least half women members: 37
- Committees holding a bank or mobile-money account: 29

2.3 Hygiene education in schools

Hygiene clubs were set up in 26 primary schools. Teachers received a two-day course and a kit containing posters, soap and water containers. Pupils in the clubs lead a handwashing session before the midday meal.[1] Head teachers report that the clubs are popular with younger pupils in particular.

3. Results by District

The table below lists every district where the initiative worked in 2025, with the number of water points and the population served. A water point counts as functional when it delivered water on the day of the inspection.

Table 1. Water points and population served by district

District	New boreholes	Rehabilitated wells	Population served	Functional at inspection
Kerewa	5	2	3,900	7 of 7
Dantaro	4	1	2,950	5 of 5
Bellafou	6	0	4,400	6 of 6
Sakoura East	3	3	3,100	5 of 6
Sakoura West	2	1	1,700	3 of 3
Mintoro	4	2	3,250	6 of 6
Gabéla	3	0	2,100	3 of 3
Tassouri	5	1	3,800	5 of 6
Ouroukou	2	2	1,900	4 of 4

[1] Schools without a canteen hold the session at the end of the morning break.

Table 1 (continued)

District	New boreholes	Rehabilitated wells	Population served	Functional at inspection
Fandiga	3	1	2,300	4 of 4
Koryan	2	0	1,200	2 of 2
Bisselé	1	1	750	2 of 2
Wandara	2	0	1,350	2 of 2
Total	**42**	**14**	**32,700**	**54 of 56**

4. Finances

Total expenditure for the year was 412,800 euros, of which 71 percent went directly to construction and rehabilitation. Administrative costs remained below the ceiling of 10 percent set by the board.

Table 2. Expenditure by category (euros)

Category	Amount	Share
Construction and rehabilitation	293,100	71%
Training and hygiene education	61,900	15%
Monitoring and inspection	20,600	5%
Administration	37,200	9%
Total	**412,800**	**100%**

5. Outlook for 2026

The board has approved a target of 50 new boreholes in 2026. The initiative will also test solar-powered pumps at four schools where the water table is deeper than 60 metres. Three priorities were agreed for the coming year.

1. Extend the programme to two new districts.
2. Replace hand pumps that are more than ten years old.
3. Publish the inspection results every quarter.